[METRIC]

A-A 1668E
February 9, 1996
SUPERSEDING
A-A-1668D
July 27, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BAG, PLASTIC, GENERAL PURPOSE (RIP-RESISTANT)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This description covers plastic bags designed to have increased rip and tear resistance. They are intended for outdoor use and for other applications where a high degree of tear resistance is required.

2. CLASSIFICATION. Bags shall be of the following types, as specified in the contract or order:

Type 1 - Medium Duty
Type 2 - Heavy Duty
Type 3 - Extra Heavy Duty

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 8105

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3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Construction. Bags furnished under this description shall be made from plastic resin, modified as necessary so that the bags conform to the requirements of Table I below for the type of bag specified in the contract or order. Bags shall be formed and sealed so as to pass the Load Capacity and Seal Continuity Tests.

Table I, Physical Properties

Characteristic	Requirement			Test Method
	Type 1	Type 2	Type 3	
Impact Resistance grams, minimum	110	165	200	ASTM D 1709 Method A
Tear Resistance grams, minimum, each direction	240	480	600	ASTM D 1922 *

* Constant radius specimen, thickness need not be measured

3.2. Dimensions. Unless otherwise specified, dimensions shall be designated as minimum face width X minimum overall height. Face width shall be defined as 50% of the circumference of the top edge of the bag.

3.3 Color. Unless otherwise specified, the bags shall be the natural color of the resin from which they are made.

3.4 Style. Unless otherwise specified, style shall be at the option of the contractor. When the seal length is less than the face width, the minimum overall height of the bag shall be increased by 0.16 times the difference in length between the face width and the seal length. This additional height is necessary to compensate for the gathering at the seal that reduces the capacity of the bag.

3.5 Load Capacity. Load capacity shall be as specified in the contract or order and shall be tested as specified in Section 5.3.1. Unless otherwise specified, full metal food cans weighing between 450 g (1.0 pound) and 910 g (2.0 pounds) each shall constitute the test load.

3.6 Seal Continuity. Seal continuity shall be tested as specified in Section 5.3.2.

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3.7 Workmanship. The bags shall be uniformly made, free from holes, tears, extraneous matter, or other defects which may impair their serviceability or appearance.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE.

5.1. Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.2 Sampling. Bags shall be selected from each lot for verification of the salient characteristics specified in Section 3. The sample shall consist of 4 bags taken from each of 5 randomly selected units of issue, giving a total sample of 20 bags.

5.2.1 Sampling for Dimensions, Style, and Workmanship. Thirteen of the bags sampled in paragraph 5.2 shall be examined for Dimensions, Style, and Workmanship. No more than 1 bag shall fail to meet the requirements of paragraph 3.2, 3.4, or 3.7.

5.2.2 Sampling for Impact Resistance. From the bags sampled in paragraph 5.2, select and test a sample for Impact Resistance in accordance with ASTM D 1709, Method A, to determine compliance with Table I. Unless otherwise specified, the procedure for Routine Inspection and Acceptance shall be used and 1 specimen shall be tested from each of 10 bags.

5.2.3 Sampling for Tear Resistance. Determine Tear Resistance on the undamaged portion of each bag that was tested for Impact Resistance. One specimen parallel to the height of the bag and 1 specimen perpendicular to the height of the bag shall be taken from each bag. Specimens shall be cut and tested in accordance with ASTM D 1922 to determine compliance with Table I.

5.2.4 Sampling for Load Capacity. Take 5 intact bags from the sample selected in paragraph 5.2 and test them for Load Capacity as specified in Section 5.3.1.

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5.2.5 Sampling for Seal Continuity. Take 5 intact bags from the sample selected in paragraph 5.2 and test them for Seal Continuity as specified in Section 5.3.2.

5.3 Testing.

5.3.1 Load Capacity Test. Bags selected for the Load Capacity test shall be placed on a smooth horizontal surface and spread open as wide as possible to facilitate inserting the test load. When cans constitute the test load, they shall be free from burrs or sharp edges. Cans shall be gently placed in the bag, 1 at a time, by hand, and shall be distributed throughout the bottom portion of the bag. Stacking is not required, but bunching up of the test load shall be avoided. After adding the test load, the bag shall be grasped or clamped within 30 cm (12 inches) of the top and raised by hand or mechanical means until the bottom of the bag is not less than 30 cm (12 inches) from the floor. The bag shall be held in this position for not less than 60 seconds. Any spillage of the test load constitutes failure of the test. Any tear in the bag more than 3 cm (1 inch) long constitutes failure of the test. If 1 or more of the 5 bags selected for this test fails, the lot shall be rejected.

5.3.2 Seal Continuity Test. Bags shall be placed in a clean container with smooth sides while adding the water. A volume of water at 21° ± 3° C (70° ± 5° F) weighing 50 ± 1% of the load capacity specified in the contract shall be poured into the bag. (Water at 21° C weighs 998 grams per liter.) The bag shall be grasped or clamped within 30 cm (12 inches) of the top, removed from the container and raised by hand or mechanical means until the bottom of the bag is not less than 30 cm (12 inches) from the floor. The bag shall be held in this position for 60 seconds. Any leakage constitutes failure of the test. If 1 or more of the 5 bags selected for this test fails, the lot shall be rejected.

6. PACKAGING, PACKING, AND MARKING: Packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

7. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS: The issues of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

7.1 Federal Regulations:

Federal Acquisition Regulation. Paragraph 23.403

Copies of the U.S. Code may be obtained through the Congressional Sales Office, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

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7.2 National standards.

ASTM methods may be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

8. Notes. Purchasers shall specify the following in the contract or purchase order:

(a) Type & size required;
(b) Weight to be used in the Load Capacity Test;
(c) Packaging required;
(d) Color (when a special color is required);
(e) Style (when a special style is required);
(f) Test Load (when a test load other than canned food is required).
(g) When the Staircase Testing Technique is to be used to test Impact Resistance.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

No official DOD interest in this commercial item description has been registered.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA -- FSS

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